

Assignment-5

1) what is flash fill and how does it work in excel.

Flash-fill is an intelligent excel feature that automatically fills values in a column by detecting patterns in the data you enter. It learns from your example and applies same logic to the remaining rows without using formulas.

How flash fill works:-

- * You enter the desired output manually for the first row.
- * Excel analyzes the pattern.
- * When you press $ctrl+E$ or select data → flash fill, excel fills the remaining cells automatically.

Ex:- Extract first Name.

FullName	firstname
KaranamVenkya	Karanam

Types of tasks flash fill can perform:-

- splitting text
- combining text
- Reformatting dates
- Removing unwanted characters
- extracting initials

2) How would you use flash fill to reformat data in a column.

Flashfill is used to change the format of existing data by recognizing a pattern from your manual entry and applying it to the entire column without formulas.

Steps to use flash fill for reformatting

- Make sure your original data is in one column.
- Insert a new column next to it.
- Type the desired format for the first value.
- Press Enter.
- Press $\text{Ctrl} + \text{E}$.
- Excel reformats all remaining rows automatically.

Ex:- Reformat Names

Original data: Karanam Vasenya

Desired format: Vasenya

Type the o/p once: - Press $\text{Ctrl} + \text{E}$

Ex:- change data format.

original :- 2026-01-22

Reformat :- 22-01-2026.

3) Can you explain the process of splitting data into columns using text to columns.

Text to columns is an excel feature used to split data from a single column into multiple columns, based on a delimited or fixed width. It is commonly used for data cleaning and formatting.

Why use Text to columns?

- When data is combined in one column.
- To separate names, dates, codes or addresses.

→ To prepare data for analysis.

Types of Text to columns:

→ Delimiter: Data is separated by character like comma, space, tab.

Ex: Varenya, Karanam.

→ Fixed width: Data is split based on specific positions.

Ex: VarenyaKaranam → Varenya | Karanam.

* select the column containing the data.

* Go to data → Text to columns.

* choose delimited or fixed width.

* click Next.

- * Select the delimiter or set column breaks.
- * Choose data format
- * Click, finish

4) What are common delimiters used in the Text to columns features?

In excel, delimiters are characters text within a cell. When using the text to columns features with the delimiter option, excel splits the data based on the selected delimiter.

Commonly used delimiters:

1) comma (,) :-

- * Most commonly used delimiter
- * Used in CSV

Ex:-

Varenya, Kazanam → Varenya | Kazanam

2) space :- It is used when data is separated by space.

3) Tab :- It is often used when copying data from web pages or text files.

4) Semicolon :- Common in European data formats.

Ex:- A ; B ; C → A | B | C

5) Hyphen (-) :- It is used in dates, codes, or IPs.

Ex:- 22-01-2026 → 22/01/2026.

6) slash (/) :- It is common in dates or file paths.

Ex:- 22/01/2026 → 22/01/2026

7) custom delimiter :-

Any special character like !, #, @

5) How do you use the len function to count the number of characters in a cell?

The len function in excel is used to count the total no. of characters in a text string, along with spaces. It helps in analyzing and validating text data.

syntax :-

=len(text)

* Text :- The cell or text string whose length you want to count

Ex:- =len("excel")

Result: 5

Practical use of len :-

* checking minimum or maximum character limits

* Password length validation

- * Identifying extra spaces
- * working with text functions like left, right, mid.

6) What is the purpose of the substitute functions and how is it used?

The substitute function in excel is used to replace specific text within a text string with new text. It is mainly used for text cleaning, correction and standardization.

Purpose:-

- * Replace unwanted words or characters
- * Clean imported or messy data
- * correct spelling/ formatting

Syntax:-

=substitute (text, old-text, new-text)

Ex:-

Replaces all occurrences

=substitute ("excel excel", "Excel", "MS Excel")

uses:-

- * Removing hyphes, commas
- * cleaning phone numbers
- * Fixing repeated text
- * Preparing data for reports

1) How would you combine the concatenate function with flashfill.
The concatenate function and flashfill are both used to combine text values. They can be used together to understand patterns and automate text joining in excel.

Explanation:-

- * Concatenate/concat combines text from multiple cells using a formula.
- * flashfill can then recognize the combined pattern and apply it to other rows without formulas.

Method 1 :- Using concatenate function

Syntax:-

=concatenate(text1, text2, ---)

Ex:- A1 = Varenaya
B1 = Karanam

=> concat(A1, " ", B1)
= Varenaya Karanam

Method 2 :- Using flash fill for the same task.

- * Type the combined value manually.
Varenaya Karanam.

-> Press ctrl + E

-> Excel fill all rows automatically.

8) Explain the difference b/w the Rept function and the substitute function.

The Rept and substitute functions are both text functions in excel, but they serve completely different purposes.

-) Rept function:- Repeats a text string a specified no of times.

* It is mainly used for formatting and visual representation.

Syntax:-

=rept (text, number, times)

Ex:- =rept ("*", 5)

Result:- *****

substitute:- Replace specific text within a string with new text.

* It is used for text cleaning and correction.

Syntax:-

=substitute (text, old-text, new-text, (instance no))

Ex:- =substitute ("A-B-C", "-", " ")

Result:- ABC

9) How can you use text to columns to convert text to dates.

Sometimes dates are stored as text, which prevents excel from performing date calculations. The text to columns features can be used to convert text-formatted dates into real excel data values.

Why this is needed?

- * Imported data (csv, txt) often stores dates as text

- * Text dates cannot be used in calculations

- * Text to columns fixes excel to recognize dates correctly.

- * Select the column containing text formatted dates.

- * Go to data -> Text to columns

- * Choose delimiter

- * Click next -> Next

- * In column data format, select date

- * Choose the correct format
dmy, mdy, ymd

- * Click finish.

Ex:- Before (Text) :- 22-01-2026

After (Text) :- 22-01-2026
(data value)

10) What is the significance of the flashfill preview in Excel.

The flashfill preview shows how excel will fill the data based on the pattern it has detected from your example before the data is actually filled. It helps users verify accuracy and avoid mistakes.

- * It confirms pattern recognition

- * It shows whether excel has understood your pattern correctly.

- * Helps you check if the output is as expected.

- * Prevents data errors.

- * You can stop flash fill if the preview is incorrect.

- * Avoid wrong formatting in large datasets.

- * Reduces the need to undo and correct mistakes.

- * Ensures correct filling in one attempt.

Ex:-

original data:- Karanam Varenya

Typed data:- Varenya